

Fig. 27.8. Ranger 2 descending toward Gargantua, as seen by Brand in the *Endurance*, with portions of two *Endurance* modules in the foreground. The Ranger is the faintly seen object in the picture's lower center, surrounded by Gargantua's accretion disk. *[From* Interstellar*, used courtesy of Warner Bros. Entertainment Inc.]*

This surely is true. But the additional thrust on the *Endurance*, from Cooper and TARS accompanying the lander and Ranger into the hole, is awfully small. The greater truth, of course, is that Cooper *wants* to go into Gargantua. He hopes that he and TARS can learn the quantum gravity laws from a singularity inside Gargantua, and somehow transmit them back to Earth. It is his last, desperate hope for saving all of humanity.

The *Endurance*'s Launch Toward Edmunds' Planet

The critical orbit is an ideal spot for Brand and the robot Case to launch the *Endurance* in any desired direction, in particular, toward Edmunds' planet.